▼ GLASSHOUSE



SWITCH OFF THE PHONE

While IT minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** has been flaunting the fact that Apple is producing iPhones in India, his other ministry, the Railways, doesn't seem to believe phones are useful for official work. The finance ministry policy permits government officers to buy laptops, tablets and mobiles to the tune of Rs 1.3 lakh for official purposes. But when the Railway Board came out with the same policy recently, officers were startled to see that it had removed 'mobile' from the list of devices. Officers were quick to spot the irony: while one ministry under Vaishnaw is pushing India as a tech hub, the other seems to be stuck on a track of its own. Entreaties to the Railway Board for a correction have so far fallen on deaf years, we're told.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ ICON-HOPPING IN UK

NATIVE PRIDE



Tamil Nadu chief minister **M.K. Stalin's** recent visit to the UK and Germany was not merely about attracting investments, though he did return with commitments worth over Rs 15,000 crore. It was equally about building some cultural capital. In the UK, he unveiled a portrait of Dravidian icon Periyar at Oxford University, paid homage at Karl Marx's resting place in Highgate Cemetery, and even called on the family of Col. John Pennycuick, the late British engineer revered in Tamil Nadu for building the 130-year-old Mullaperiyar dam. Going by sheer optics, it would seem there's no better trustee than Stalin of TN's 'self-respect' movement.